

it for serious work, go ahead and explore the options. You can always remove the virtual machine and create a new one (by the way, creating a new one and installing the OS in it does take time!). In case you're new to virtualization and want to use the virtual machine for some serious work, we don't recommend this option.

Assuming you chose the "Typical" installation method, you'll be presented with the options for source of the OS you want to install on the virtual machine. You have three options:

- ▶ **Install from a physical drive:** Here, you choose one of your DVD / CD drives (in case you have more than one). You need to put the guest OS installation media in the disk before you install. Workstation will try to automatically determine the OS within.
- ▶ **Use ISO image:** You can use an ISO image of the OS. Once again, Workstation will try to guess the OS on the media. If it makes a wrong guess, you should select the third option: "I will install the operating system later" and after creation of the virtual machine, open its settings and select the media (DVD/CD drive or an ISO file) before you launch it.

I will install the operating system later: You can use this option if you haven't decided on the OS yet or don't have the installation media. If you select this, VMware Workstation will ask you to manually set the OS you're going to use within the virtual machine.

If and when VMware Workstation tries to guess the OS inside the installation media, it allows you to provide the details for installation which includes the username and password for the OS. The feature is called "Easy install". In case of Windows, it would additionally ask you for the CD key of the OS. We wouldn't recommend providing that information before creating the virtual machine; install it normally. The

reasons might not be obvious until you've actually finished the installation. At times, we found that the root user password in the guest OS wasn't set correctly and in case of Windows, a different time zone was selected. In case of a Windows XP guest, it caused problems because the full name of the user was two words and included a blank space.

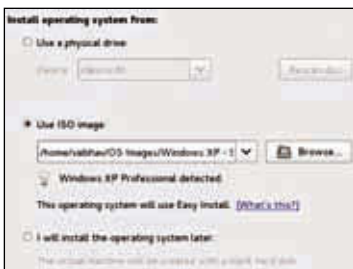


Figure 6: VMware easy install detects the OS inside the supplied media automatically